3. Does not require any skill or specific equipment.

Demerits:

1. Takes a long time for cooking the food.
2. Precaution must be taken to ensure that the food does not get burnt.

iii) Poaching

This involves cooking in the minimum amount of liquid at a temperature of 80°–85°C. Foods generally poached are eggs and fish.

Merits:

1. No special equipment is needed.
2. It is a quick method of cooking and thus saves fuel.
3. Poached foods are easily digested as no fat is added.

Demerits:

1. Poached foods may not appeal to everybody as they are bland to taste.
2. Foods can get burnt if not monitored closely.
3. Water soluble nutrients may be lost if they are leached into the water.

iv) Stewing

This is a gentle method of cooking in a pan with a tight fitting lid, using small quantities of liquid to cover only half the food. The liquid is brought to a boiling point and then the heat applied is reduced to maintain the cooking at simmering temperature ie., 98°C. Apples can be cooked by this method.

Merits:

1. Loss of nutrients is avoided as the water used for cooking is not discarded.
2. Flavour is retained.

Demerits:

1. The process is time consuming and there is wastage of fuel.

v) Steaming

This method requires the food to be cooked in steam. This is generated from vigorously boiling water or liquid in a pan so that the food is completely surrounded by steam and not in contact with the water or liquid. Here the food gets cooked at 100 degrees.

Merits:

1. Less chances of burning.
2. Texture of food is better, as it is made light and fluffy.
3. Saves time and fuel.
4. Steamed foods like idli and idiappam have very negligible fat and are easy to digest, and are good for children, elderly and therapeutic diets.

Demerits:

1. Steaming equipment is required.
2. This method is limited to the preparation of selected foods.

vi) Pressure cooking

In pressure cooking escaping steam is trapped and kept under pressure so that the temperature of the boiling water and steam can be raised above 100°C thus reducing cooking time. Foods cooked in pressure cooker are rice, dhal, vegetables and meat.

Merits:

1. Cooking time is less compared to other methods.
2. Nutrient and flavour loss is minimized.
3. Conserves time, fuel and different items can be cooked at the same time.
4. Less chance of burning.
5. Constant monitoring is not necessary.

Demerits:

1. The initial investment cost may not be affordable by everybody.

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